



## What is your sexual orientation?

|                                           | Male | Female |
|-------------------------------------------|------|--------|
| Homosexual and out of the closet <b>3</b> | 3    | 3      |
| Homosexual but not out of closet <b>4</b> | 4    | 4      |
| <b>Heterosexual 81</b>                    | 80   | 82     |
| <b>Bisexual 6</b>                         | 8    | 4      |

Rest Don't Know/Can't Say

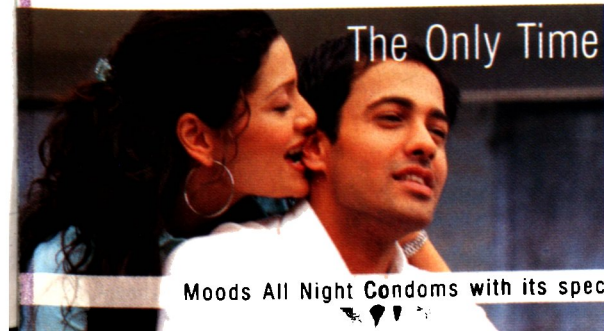
All figures in per cent

**Five per cent of married respondents admitted they were bisexual.**

uphold "Indian culture and values". It is ironic that for Singhal, a piece of colonial legislation should come to the rescue of "Indian culture and values". I describe the dramatis personae and their scripts in some detail because this unfolding narrative could be an allegory of contemporary India's contestations around sexuality.

The INDIA TODAY-AC Nielsen-ORG MARG sex survey is bad news for traditional moralists but for everyone else, an opportunity to learn how diverse our sexual cultures are. Responding anonymously, men and women from four metros and seven major cities share information about their sexual preferences and practices. The survey demonstrates the decline in conventional inhibitions and a greater openness to a range of sexual practices that lie outside the ambit of marriage, monogamy and heterosexuality. There seems to be an increasing willingness on the part of the people to talk about their sexual lives when anonymity is guaranteed. Clearly, the silence around hitherto taboo topics like queer sexuality, extramarital relationships (unfortunately called "adultery" in the study) and pornography are definitively broken. Take the findings on pornography for instance. According to the survey, three out of every five men and one out of every five women "approve" of pornography. Since pornography has always been considered a male preserve, it is worth noting that 21 per cent of the women respondents approve of pornography out of which 45 per cent have been inspired to be sex-

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